

shop around, and if you are lucky, even some freebies with the purchase. For connectivity, you get USB2.0, and in some high-end models you may be given the Firewire.

Let's Hear It For MFDs

At the same time, some users may not want to invest in a scanner alone. For such users, a more viable option would be a Multi-Functional Device. MFDs seem to have caught everyone's fancy of late. An MFD is a device that incorporates the functionality of a printer, copier, scanner and fax-all in one machine. The most basic ones start at Rs 5K, which is just Rs 2K more than a scanner.

Essentially, for less than the price of a standalone printer and a single scanner you get a device that does all that and more! However, the drawback of MFDs is maintenance, since if they conk off, you can't perform any of the individual functions till the entire MFD is repaired. On the other hand, if you had single-use devices, even if your printer failed, your work would not come to



A high-end scanner